

Expression of Interest

Working Group 2: Safe Roads, Speeds & Vulnerable Road Users

Submitted to the National Road Safety Board

by Crashfree India (Vision Zero Trust) · August 2026

1M+ people reached

18 cities

25+ authority approvals

4 district committees

Crashfree India: a nonprofit working for safer roads

Registered as Vision Zero Trust. Co-founded by Cars24 and the Indian Road Safety Council, June 2025. We follow the global Vision Zero principle: no loss of life on the road is acceptable.

 **Evidence first** Structured field audits, file reviews and research to official standards — not opinion.

 **Institutional collaboration** We work through PWDs, NHAI, transport departments, police and District Road Safety Committees.

 **Youth-led capacity** Trained student teams from IITs, NITs and SPAs add auditing hands the system needs.

 **Technology for follow-through** Public dashboards track every recommendation from submission to completion.

Backed by a US\$3 million, three-year commitment from Cars24 — with programmes, not overheads, receiving 71% of the budget.

One year of work across four connected areas

Each area strengthens the others — audits create data, data supports policy, policy guides the field.



Project Rakshak

Youth-led road safety audits to IRC / MoRTH standards; 31 sites, 25+ approvals, 15 implementations underway.



SATARK & enforcement technology

AI number-plate platform built with traffic police — 3,00,000+ vehicles screened in Jaipur & Bengaluru.



Post-crash support & compensation

'Justice Unserved' research, Aasha chatbot, hospital helpdesks, district committee integration, Rajasthan portal design.

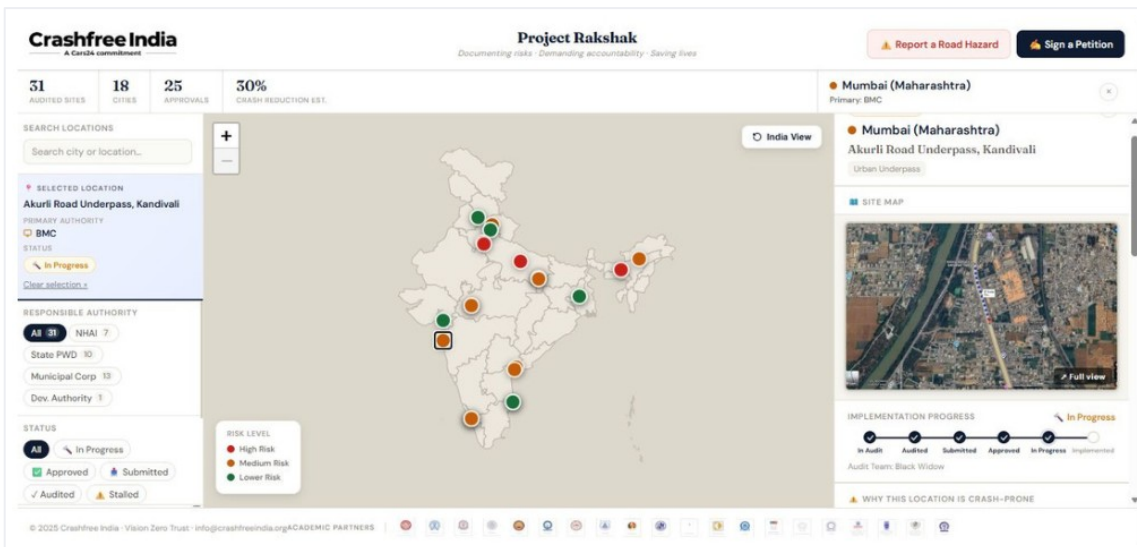


Open data & public education

Four public data platforms; comics, Hindi guides and a pre-hospital care primer.

We build serious public technology — and keep it open

Self-updating platforms that make road-safety work transparent, measurable and usable by government.



Project Rakshak public dashboard — every site, authority and status visible.

Rakshak accountability portal — rakshak.crashfreeindia.org — submission → committee ratification → completion

SATARK enforcement platform — ANPR + national vehicle records, officer app and public compliance billboards

Aasha — 24/7 multilingual AI guide for crash victims, on WhatsApp and voice

Compensation Calculator — Free estimates on Supreme Court principles (Sarla Verma, Pranay Sethi)

National crash data dashboard — MoRTH statistics productised: report cards for 36 states, 50 cities

Road defect repository — AI reads local news in 13 languages across 146 districts; hazards mapped publicly

OUR PEOPLE

Academic leadership, senior advisors and a multidisciplinary team



Prof. Geetam Tiwari

Emeritus Professor & Chair, TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi · Member, IRC H-7 Committee on Road Safety Audit



Piyush Tewari

Founder & CEO, SaveLIFE Foundation · Architect of the Good Samaritan Law

BOARD OF ADVISORS

Guided also by Dr. Richa Ahuja (IIT Kharagpur) and an expert network spanning CSIR-CRRI, IRF India, CoERS IIT Madras, IISc, IIT Bombay, IIT Roorkee, IIT Kanpur and the Schools of Planning & Architecture.

Trustees

Amar Srivastava (Founder, Indian Road Safety Council) · Deepanshu Gupta (Founder, IRSC) · Gajendra Jangid (Co-founder, Cars24)

Full-time team

Educated at IIT Delhi, NALSAR & Delhi University (law), TISS (development studies), HKUST — experience across engineering, law, policy, psychology and product

Field strength

75+ road-engineering interns and 31 student audit teams across 18 cities

Goodwill Ambassador

MS Dhoni — voice for youth participation and safer school zones

The mandate, and where we align

Safe roads, speed management and the protection of vulnerable road users.

Road design	Black spots	Speed limits	School zones	Pedestrians	Cyclists
Black-spot rectification		31 sites audited in year one — 11 official blackspots among them — with 25+ authority approvals and 15 implementations underway.			
Road design to standard		Every audit anchored in IRC codes and MoRTH checklists, guided by a member of the IRC H-7 Committee on Road Safety Audit.			
Speed & school zones		Speed-calming measures in approved designs; college-led school-zone screening under exploration.			
Vulnerable road users		Dedicated research on two-wheeler and gig-rider risk — the largest VRU category — plus pedestrian-first audit findings.			

THE OPPORTUNITY

Identification has outpaced rectification — capacity is the constraint

The knowledge exists; the pipeline that turns identified risk into completed engineering needs more hands, and better tracking.

13,795

black spots identified nationally (MoRTH)

5,036

permanently rectified so far (Parliamentary Standing Committee, 2024)

44

certified Road Safety Auditors on the national registry (July 2026)



Low-cost engineering measures — raised crossings, traffic calming, lighting, safer intersections — reduce crashes by 20–80% (IRF conference, Prof. Geetam Tiwari).



Roughly 80% of crashes are attributed to 'human error', yet outcomes are shaped most by the road environment people operate in — which is fixable by design.

Project Rakshak was designed for precisely this constraint: trained, supervised auditing capacity that supports road-owning agencies — and tracks every fix to completion.

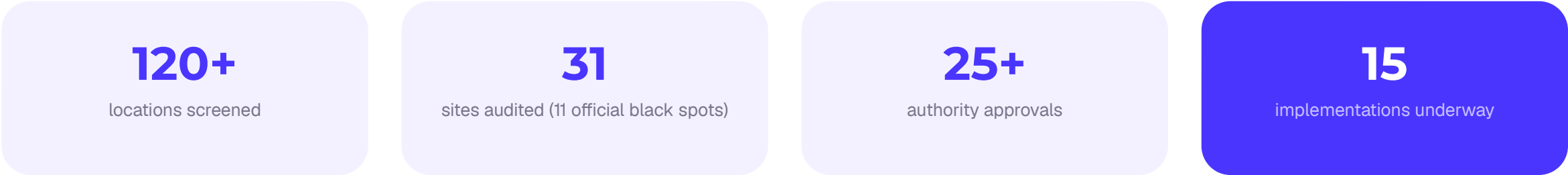
A structured, standards-based audit programme

Conceptualised and guided by Prof. Geetam Tiwari (TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi) and Dr. Richa Ahuja (IIT Kharagpur).



-  Teams train under expert masterclasses (Prof. Tiwari on the Safe System approach; Dr. S. Velmurugan, CSIR-CRRI, on the 5Es and IRC-131).
-  Every recommendation is presented to the road-owning authority in its own format — and tracked publicly after submission.

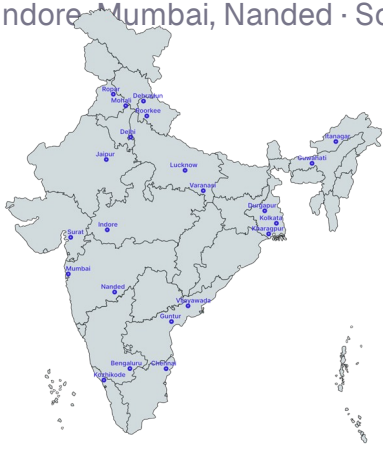
Cohort 1: a national footprint in the first year



31 student teams · 20 institutions including nine IITs · 900+ stakeholder surveys · guided by 8 mentors and independent evaluators

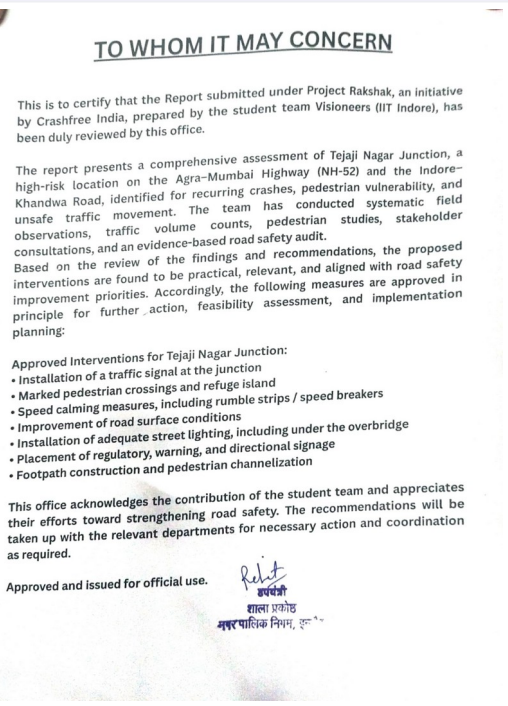
North: Ropar, Dehradun, Roorkee, Delhi · Uttar Pradesh: Lucknow, Varanasi · East: Guwahati, Durgapur · West & Central: Surat, Indore, Mumbai, Nanded · South: Vijayawada, Guntur, Kozhikode, Chennai — among others.

Example: Tejaji Nagar Junction, Indore — an official black spot; redesign approved by CPWD and the Additional Collector's office.

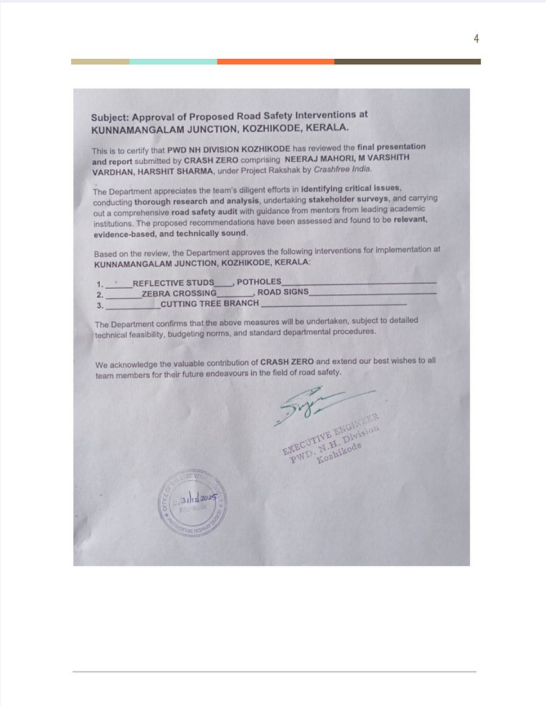


Authority approvals, in writing

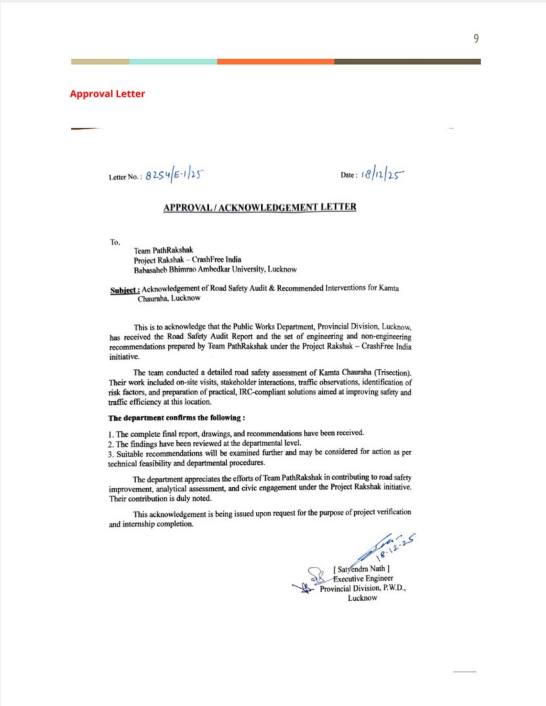
A sample of the 25+ approval and acknowledgement letters issued by public works and district authorities.



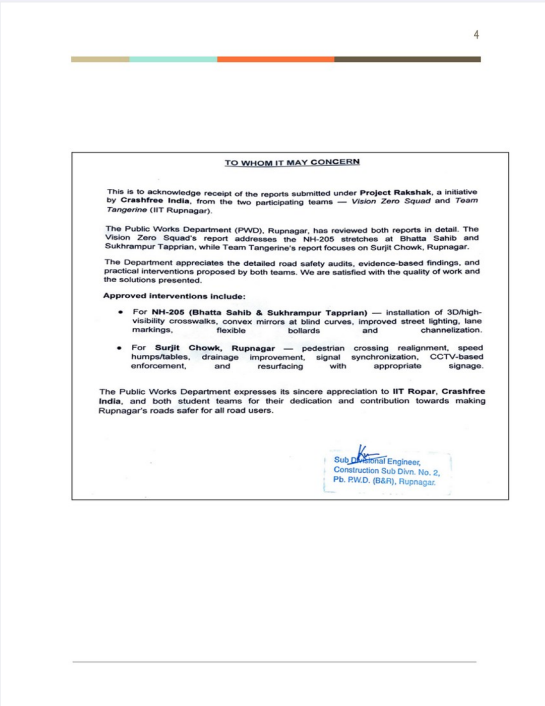
Tejaji Nagar, Indore



Kozhikode — PWD Kerala



Lucknow — PWD (UP)



Ropar — PWD (Punjab)

Approving authorities include PWD Kerala, PWD Uttar Pradesh, PWD Punjab, CPWD & the Additional Collector (Indore), ADDA Durgapur, R&B Andhra Pradesh and GCC Chennai.

From approval to construction: implementations under way

Parking, drainage, road markings, signage, footpaths and barricading — city by city.



Parking — Durgapur



Road works — Durgapur



Drainage — Guntur



Barricading — Indore



Footpath — Indore

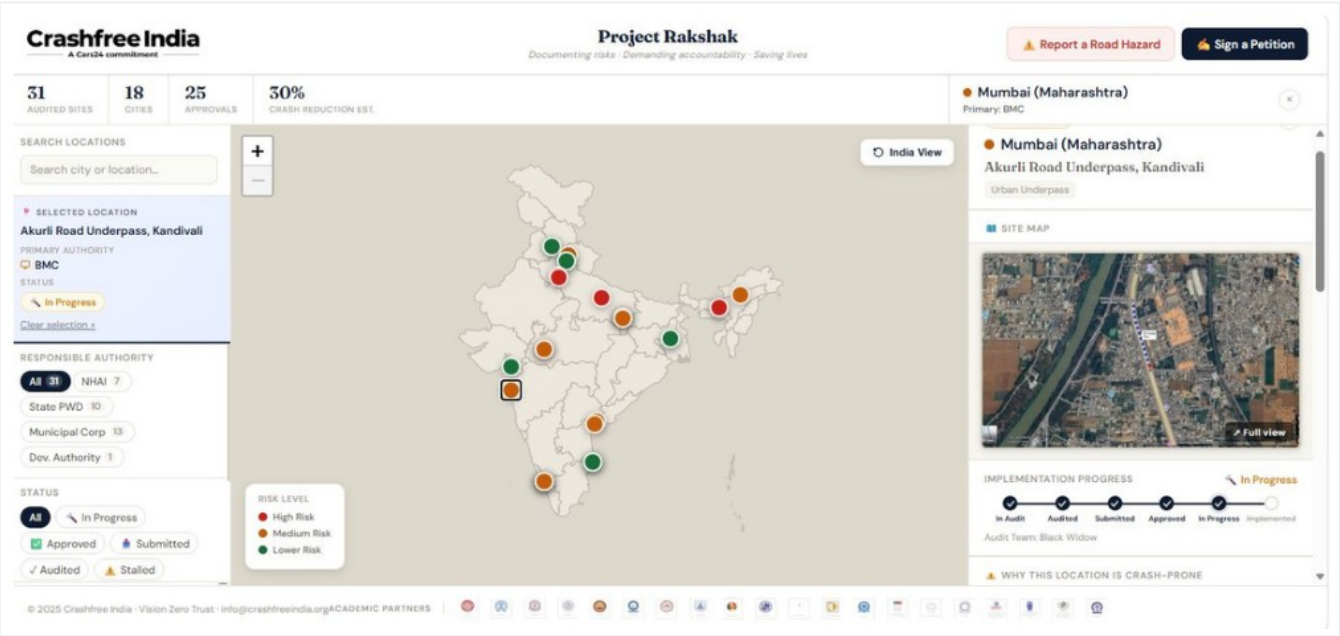


Markings — Guntur

Estimated 20–50% crash reduction at treated sites once complete, based on WHO / iRAP evidence for these counter-measures — to be verified with before/after data.

A public portal that tracks every site to completion

The design principle: transparency, not repeated follow-up, is what moves a recommendation from acknowledgement to action.



rakshak.crashfreeindia.org — live public accountability portal.

Every site tracked — From submission through DRSC ratification to engineering completion — regardless of who audited it.

The PRAGATI parallel — The PMO's PRAGATI platform resolved 7,150+ of ~7,700 flagged issues across ₹85 lakh crore of projects — public, real-time review works at national scale.

What the Board gains — A live, honest read on how quickly road-owning agencies can act — evidence for capacity planning, not just compliance.

Why this model scales: three tracks, one standard

Cohort 2 matches each road type to the right auditing capacity — reserving scarce certified auditors for the most complex sites.

Track	Road type	Implementing authority	Who audits
A — Institutional	Urban arterials, in-town state highways, district roads	ULB, State / District PWD	IIT / NIT / SPA teams under expert mentors, IRC-aligned rubric
B — NGO partners	District & peri-urban corridors	District PWD, ULB	NGO field teams; desk-reviewed, share re-verified by CFI
C — Certified RSAs	National Highways, complex junctions	NHAI Project Director, State PWD	CSIR-CRRI-certified auditors; full IRC SP:88; usable by NHAI without rework



Site selection in Cohort 2 is anchored to locations that district administrations, DRSCs and road-owning agencies have themselves flagged as priorities.

Built to be institutionalised — not to depend on us

Our role narrows over time to standard-setter and platform steward; the ecosystem runs the audits.

Today

CFI runs cohorts, quality-controls audits and stewards the public portal

Next

Rakshak Audit Manual v1.0 codifies the method; universities field their own teams; NGOs run Track B directly

Mature state

States engage certified RSAs for Track C without CFI as intermediary; the portal remains the shared public record



The same standards-anchored approach is being explored for school-zone safety — college-led screening under the same public-tracking discipline.

OUR NETWORK

The technical bench behind the audits

Mentors, evaluators and forum experts who review and strengthen every cohort's work.



Prof. Geetam Tiwari

TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi · IRC H-7



Dr. Richa Ahuja

IIT Kharagpur



Dr. S. Velmurugan

Chief Scientist, CSIR-CRRI



Akhilesh Srivastava

President, IRF India



Dr. A. M. Rao

Chief Scientist, CSIR-CRRI



Rama Shankar Pandey

FICCI Road Safety Roundtable



Prof. Ashish Verma

IISc Bengaluru



Prof. Satish Chandra

IIT Roorkee



Prof. Gopal R. Patil

IIT Bombay

Plus mentors and evaluators from KPMG, EY, CTRANS, SVNIT Surat, SPA Vijayawada & Bhopal, IIT Mandi, Vignan's University and the TRIP Centre — and forum participation from MoRTH, WHO, UNICEF, WRI, IFFCO Tokyo, district administrations and traffic police leadership.

This bench is available to the Working Group for drafting, review and technical input on road design, speed and VRU standards.

Youth mobilisation that keeps the model supplied

Scaling audits needs a steady flow of trained, motivated young engineers and planners — we have built that funnel.

700+

ideathon registrations (IITs, IIMs, NLUs)

250+

policy concept notes

37

teams mentored

10

finalists judged by 24 experts



NextMile (2025), our national road-safety policy ideathon, closed at India Habitat Centre with a jury including Justice J.R. Midha and former MoRTH leadership.



Winning tracks — blackspot identification, speed management, delivery-rider safety — feed directly into our audit and research pipeline.



Next: 'Be a Rakshak' university chapters at IITs, NITs and SPAs, with MS Dhoni as the recruiting voice — a self-renewing national audit corps.

A growing evidence base on those most at risk

Two-wheeler riders and pedestrians carry most of the burden — our research follows them specifically.



Gig & delivery riders

'When Risks Become Routine' (Feb 2026): incentive pressure, helmet compliance, training gaps and data fragmentation — now being quantified through a 300-rider study across Delhi NCR.



Pedestrian-first audits

Rakshak audits document crossings, footpaths and lighting as designable protections — 900+ stakeholder surveys included road users themselves.



School zones

College-led, standards-based school-zone screening under exploration as the next extension of the audit platform.



Enforcement that protects VRUs

SATARK helps police prioritise the small share of vehicles with the worst records — targeted, fair and technology-led.

Four concrete contributions to Working Group 2

- 1

Ready evidence for standard-setting

Site-level audit data, crash-pattern analysis and intervention designs across emerging hotspots and official black spots — a working evidence base for rectification protocols and speed-management guidance.
- 2

A live testing ground

Active district relationships in Gurugram, South-West Delhi and Jaipur offer a ready pipeline to pilot or stress-test draft recommendations before national rollout.
- 3

Ground-level implementation diagnostics

Granular, field-verified insight into how DRSCs function — meeting cadence, data use, follow-through — to inform the Group's governance recommendations.
- 4

Technical bench strength on request

Our academic and expert network stands ready for drafting, review and technical input on road design, speed and VRU standards.

RECOGNITION

A young organisation the ecosystem already engages with



National Road Safety Implementation Forum, IIT Delhi — April 2026.

National forum at IIT Delhi — 60+ experts; MoRTH, WHO, UNICEF, IRF and CSIR-CRRI participation; hosted with the TRIP Centre

MS Dhoni, Goodwill Ambassador — announced at the forum; covered by Business Standard, The Tribune and The Wire

Research in national press — 'Justice Unserved' covered by Deccan Herald, Economic Times, Fortune India, IndiaSpend, Moneycontrol, Scroll.in and The Wire

Government partnerships — MoUs with Jaipur Traffic Police & Gurugram Police; formal tasking by the South-West Delhi DRSC; Rajasthan Transport Department engagement

We would be honoured to contribute to Working Group 2.

Our evidence, our district relationships, our technology and our expert network are available to the Board — in whichever form is most useful.

 crashfreeindia.org

 helpdesk@crashfreeindia.org

 Live portal: rakshak.crashfreeindia.org